MIL-T-36989A
28 June 1978
SUPERSEDING
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23 July 1973

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

TUBE, SPECIMEN, PINWORM

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a sterile, disposable pinworm specimen tube, suitable for collection of pinworms, pollen, spores, dust and other fine particles.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-636	- Boxes, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676	- Boxes, Setup.

MILITARY

MIL-S-36586	- Sterilization Test Strip Set, Bacterial Spore.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	- Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	- Marking for Shipment and Storage.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Defense Personnel Support Center, Directorate of Medical Materiel, ATTN: DPSC-ATT, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 6640

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(Copies of specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer).

2.2 Other publications. The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals shall apply.

U. S. PHARMACOPEIAL CONVENTION, INC.

Pharmacopeia of the United States

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, PA 18042).

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Material shall be of the highest quality throughout and shall be as hereinafter specified.

3.2 Design and construction. The pinworm specimen tube shall consist of a tube with cap closure fixed to and suspending a paddle member within the tube. The pinworm specimen tube shall be completely enclosed in an envelope.

3.2.1 Envelope. An envelope or other suitable type container shall completely enclose the assembled pinworm specimen tube. The envelope shall be adequately sealed and shall maintain sterility of the tube and contents until manually opened (see 4.4.1). Closure or flap of the envelope shall be so constructed as to afford easy access to the enclosed pinworm specimen tube.

3.2.2 Tube. The tube shall be fabricated of clear, rigid polystyrene plastic and shall be provided with a reinforced lip around the periphery of its open end. The tube shall be a nominal 17 millimeters (mm) in diameter by a nominal 100 mm in length.

* 3.2.3 Cap closure. The cap closure, less the paddle, shall be fabricated of polyethylene plastic. The paddle shall be fabricated of clear, polyethylene plastic. The paddle shall have rounded corners and one surface shall be coated with adhesive suitable for the intended purpose. The paddle shall have nominal dimensions of 40 mm in length by 13 mm in width by 1 mm in thickness.

3.3 Sterility. The pinworm specimen tube shall be sterile when tested with a biological indicator as specified (see 4.4.1).

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3.3.1 Certificate of sterility. A certificate of sterility, stating that samples from each sterilizer lot have been tested and found to be sterile, shall be submitted to the procuring activity. The certificate of sterility shall include:

a. Item Identification.
b. National Stock Number.
c. Contract or purchase order number.
d. Sterility lot or control number.
e. Date of sterilization.
f. Quantity of product in sterilizer lot.
g. Type of sterilization (gas, radiation, heat, steam, etc.).
h. Form of biological indicator (i.e., inoculated paper spore strip or carrier, inoculated product, or inoculated simulated product).
i. Test organism(s) and population density used.
j. Test medium, incubation temperature, incubation time and dates of tests.
k. Number of test units.
l. Statement that samples comply with sterility tests.
m. Signature of head of laboratory or a designated qualified alternate.

When inspection is made at destination, the certificate of sterility shall be submitted by the contractor to the Directorate of Medical Materiel, ATTN: DPSC-ATQ, Defense Personnel Support Center, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, and a copy forwarded with each shipment to the consignee. When inspection is made at source, certificate of sterility shall be furnished to the cognizant Government Quality Assurance Representative for submission to the procuring activity.

3.3.2 Sterility lot. A sterility lot is that single quantity of product subjected to the same manufacturing operation and simultaneously sterilized with a sterility lot (control) number and date of sterilization as specified in 5.3.2. Each sterility lot shall be traceable to the pertinent manufacturing lot(s).

3.4 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. Unit shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability. Envelope shall be adequately sealed, free of tears or holes and shall provide easy access to pinworm specimen tube. Tube shall be free of sharp edges, protrusions, holes, cracks or tears. Closure shall be securely in place on tube and shall be free of sharp edges, protrusions, holes, cracks or tears. Paddle shall be secured to cap, shall be free of kinks or bends and shall have one side coated with an adhesive free of dirt and foreign matter.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

* 4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three (3) years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and table I. Sample unit shall be one pinworm specimen tube.

TABLE I. Sampling for examination.

	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
For visual examination		
Major defects	S-4	1.0
Minor defects	S-4	2.5
For dimensional examination	S-1	2.5

4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and table II.

TABLE II. Sampling for tests.

Component (unit of product)	Characteristic test	Requirement	Test procedure	Inspection level	AQL
Pinworm specimen tube	Sterility	3.3	4.4.1	S-3	*

* Acceptance number shall be zero.

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4.3 Examination. The pinworm specimen tube shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification.

4.3.1 Classification of defects. Examination shall be conducted in accordance with table III classification of defects.

TABLE III. Classification of defects.

Categories	Defects*
Major	
101	Component missing.
102	Envelope not free of tears or holes.
103	Envelope not adequately sealed.
104	Envelope does not afford easy access to the pinworm specimen tube.
105	Marking on envelope not complete, correct or legible.
106	Closure and tube not free of holes, cracks or tears.
107	Closure not securely in place.
108	Paddle not secured to cap.
109	Paddle face not coated with adhesive.
110	Paddle adhesive not free of dirt or foreign matter.
Minor	
201	Paddle not free of kinks or bends.
202	Closure and tube not free of sharp edges or protrusions.

* Examination shall be restricted to the above listed defects.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Sterility test. The pinworm specimen tube shall be tested for sterility in accordance with the method specified in the U.S.P. for non-parenteral devices using inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). Product containing a biological indicator shall be marked or labeled so that it clearly differentiates from product intended for distribution. The incubation medium and minimum time in each case shall be soybean casein digest for 7 days for inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). The incubation temperature shall be as indicated in 4.4.1.1. The minimum number of test units, regardless of lot size, shall be 10, except for inoculated type II Sterilization including inoculated carrier and product test units. The inspection level shall be as indicated in table II.

4.4.1.1 Inoculated product or simulated product. For each type of sterilization, the organism used shall be as listed below.

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Type of Sterilization	Organism	Incubation Temperature
Steam	B. stearothermophilus	55° - 65° C.
Dry heat	B. stearothermophilus, or	55° - 65° C.
	B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30° - 35° C.
Gas	B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30° - 35° C.
Radiation	B. pumilus	30° - 35° C.

The number of viable cells shall be sufficient to provide assurance that the product has been sterilized.

4.4.1.2 Inoculated carrier. Inoculated carriers (paper spore strips) if used shall be in accordance with MIL-S-36586. Other paper carriers shall be inoculated to be of equivalent resistance. The method of incubation and number of test units shall be as indicated in 4.4.1 and 4.4.1.1. The method of sterilization will control the organism in the spore strip to be tested for as shown in 4.4.1.1.

NOTE: When an inoculated carrier is chosen, product samples must also be tested as required by the U.S.P.

4.4.1.3 Alternate method. Suppliers conducting sterility tests or designating lots in a manner other than that indicated herein, shall submit proof that the alternate method provides equal assurance concerning the sterility of the product. However, all sterility tests shall be conducted using biological indicators. Requests for approval of any alternate method of testing for sterility shall be made to the Contracting Officer, and approval obtained before employment of the alternate method on a government contract.

* 4.5 Packaging inspection. The inspection of the unit package, packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of the applicable container specification and the marking requirements of MIL-STD-129.

* 5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One box containing two hundred individually packaged specimen tubes, as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.2 Level A.

5.1.2.1 Individual package. Each assembled tube shall be packaged in a bag of appropriate size and design. The bag shall be fabricated of paper, plastic, or a combination of paper and plastic. The bag shall be sealed in such a manner to insure sterility and to facilitate easy opening. The bag shall not be capable of being resealed.

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5.1.2.2 Unit package. Two hundred individually packaged tubes shall be neatly packaged in a snug-fitting box constructed in accordance with PPP-B-676, except that commercial colors are acceptable or PPP-B-636 type CF, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.1.3 Level C. Two hundred tubes, individually packaged as specified in 5.1.2.1, shall be packaged in a manner that will afford adequate protection against deterioration and physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Six unit packages shall be packed in a shipping container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Closure, strapping and waterproofing shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Six unit packages shall be packed in a shipping container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The packaged tubes shall be packed in shipping containers that will afford adequate protection against damage during direct shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. These packs shall conform to the carriers rules and regulations.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Individual package. In addition to any commercial markings, each individual package shall be marked with the sterility lot number.

5.3.2 Unit package. Each unit package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Sterility lot (control) number, contract or purchase order number, and name of contractor shall be shown. In addition, the method of sterilization (G-Gas, R-Radiation, C-Cold, S-Steam, D-Dry Heat Sterilization) shall be shown following the level and date of packaging. Example: "A9/78-G". Each unit package shall also be marked with the legend or similar statement: "STERILITY GUARANTEED UNLESS INTERIOR PACKAGES ARE DAMAGED OR OPENED".

5.3.3 Shipping container. Shipping container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Sterility lot (control) number and method of sterilization as specified in 5.3.2 shall be shown.

NOTE: Final sterilization shall be on or after indicated packaging date.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The item covered by this specification is intended for use in collecting pinworms, pollen, spores, dust and other fine particles.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) National Stock Number (NSN).
(c) Selection of applicable level of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 This specification covers the following item listed in the Federal Supply Catalog:

National Stock Number	Item Identification
6640-00-926-8959	TUBE, SPECIMEN, Pinworm, Disposable, 200s

6.4 This specification does not cover all types, classes, grades or sizes of the commodity indicated by the title of this specification, or those which are commercially available, but is intended to cover the type normally procured to meet military requirements.

* 6.5 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this specification are mark with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, correction deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

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Review activity:
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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER *(Number)* AND TITLE

MIL-T-36989A TUBE, SPECIMEN, PINWORM

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS OF SUBMITTER

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